

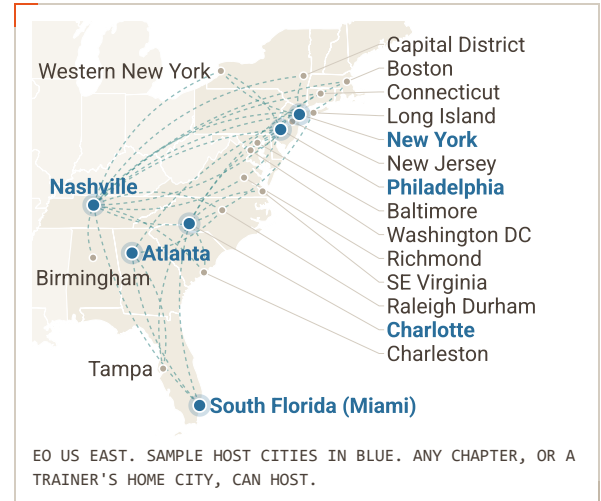
[A PILOT TO TEST]

REGIONAL TRAINING DAYS

An idea for any chapter to pick up and run with. Intake classes are shrinking, so instead of a thin small-group FTP, a virtual session, or a wait for a class of six, pool new members from several chapters into one full training day, hosted by a different city each quarter.

HOW IT RUNS

1. **Pick a host city.** Near the end of each quarter, one chapter hosts. Or fly members to a trainer's home city and the trainer's travel cost goes away.
2. **Dinner the night before.** The trainer joins when they can, so they know the room before they lead it.
3. **Make the locals the welcome committee.** Invite the host chapter's board, or the whole chapter, to the dinner. Gregarious members love meeting EO'ers from out of town, and they become ambassadors to the new class. No one has to bring an apple pie.
4. **Train all day, fly home that evening.** Wrap in time for late-afternoon flights.



WHY IT WORKS

FOR NEW MEMBERS

- ✓ Their chapter flew them out to their training, and they see how big EO really is.
- ✓ They make friends in other chapters who show up at regional events.
- ✓ Friday trainings turn into weekend trips.

FOR CHAPTERS

- ✓ A full training room. No \$250-per-person fees for empty seats.
- ✓ Trainer travel split several ways, or gone.
- ✓ Less fighting over preferred trainers' dates, and fewer trainers capped out before July 1.
- ✓ Better retention: forum members who visit outside their chapter renew at 95%.*

COSTS AND BUDGET

Venue. A local member's fancy restaurant, with the owner invited to dinner. It beats a hotel ballroom.

Flights. Each chapter books its own members' travel.

Dinner. The host chapter covers it, or each chapter chips in \$100 to \$200 per member it sends.

Trainer. Travel split across chapters, or zero when the training is in the trainer's home city.

RUN IT AS A PILOT

Test it this year. Ask the region for Forum, Membership, or Engagement funds to offset some of the costs.

*Prior data: a member who has visited an event outside their local chapter and is in forum has a 95% renewal rate.